CLEANASAURUS · ALPHA

"STORAGE ALMOST FULL."

One developer ran a cleanup tool on their laptop and found **58.68 GB** in **128** old `node_modules` folders.

Most of them can be rebuilt with one command. Almost nobody deletes them, because deleting the **wrong** folder the night before a deadline costs you your project.

Source: Flavio Copes, ”npkill” (flaviocopes.com/npkill). Nate Kim · Nate Park · Wesley Chang

PENDING: confirm these numbers against Nate Kim's raw session evidence before presenting. Remove this banner when confirmed.

MVP VALIDATION · n = 10 (5 CS, 5 non-CS) · planned 15

Testers trusted the app. It didn't free the space they needed.

KPI	TARGET	RESULT	
Ran a plan in session 1 (trust)	≥ 60%	**70%**	MET
Unsafe actions reaching a tester (trust)	0	**0**	MET
Actions undone (trust)	≤ 10%	**11%**	CLOSE
Used again within 3 days (value)	≥ 40%	**30%**	CLOSE
Space freed vs. space wanted (value)	≥ 50%	**~2%**	MISSED

Outcome: PIVOT. Trust held; value failed. And our own bug: FREED showed 12.4 GB while **0 bytes** left the disk, because the Dino Bin was on the same drive.

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PIVOT: CS STUDENTS' REBUILDABLE DEV CLUTTER

38 GB

median rebuildable dev clutter per CS tester

1.4 GB

median duplicates our MVP could free

5 of 5 CS testers named a place the MVP wouldn't go.

The competition, honestly

CleanMyMac CLI (MacPaw, developer preview) already purges `node_modules` older than 7 days and clears Xcode DerivedData. npkill and DevCleaner each do one ecosystem.

What none of them do

- **Prove** a folder is rebuildable: lockfile, gitignored, no uncommitted work, no secrets
- Save the exact rebuild command
- Let Claude map "I'm done with CS 3140" to projects

LIVE DEMO · END TO END · 3½ MIN

One request, from a full disk to space back

1

Open a messy `~/code`: 8 projects, a VM, one with a `.env` secret

2

Type: "I'm done with CS 3140 and the hackathon. Free up space."

3

Claude matches "CS 3140" and "hackathon" to projects and writes the plan

4

Validator rejects what it can't prove (the hackathon has uncommitted work). The reason goes back; try 2 passes

5

Approve: space freed, measured on disk. Undo shows the rebuild commands

Claude decides

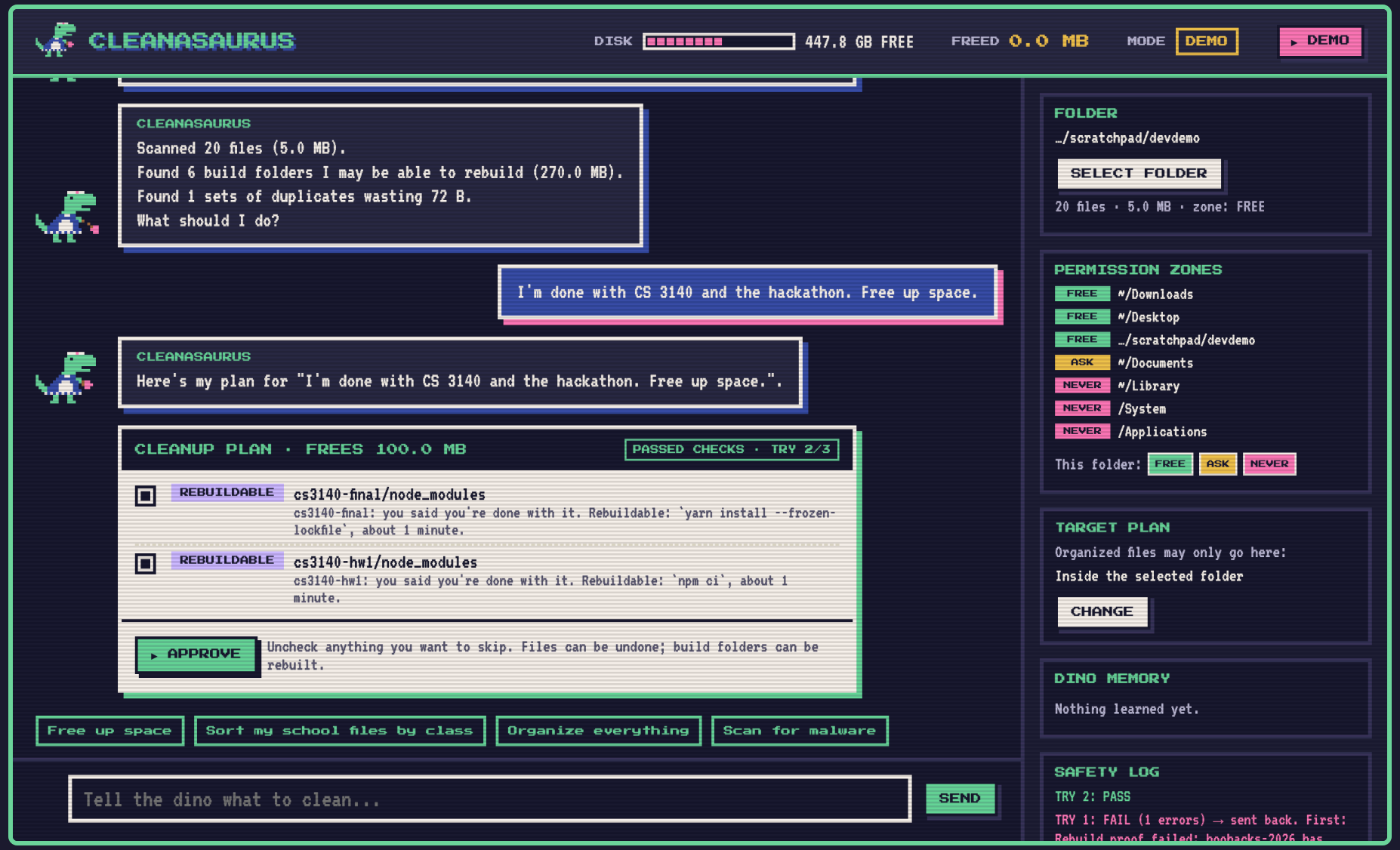
Which projects "done with CS 3140" means · how to explain each action · when to ask instead of guess

Plain code decides

Whether a folder can be deleted (the rebuild proof) · what was really freed · nothing runs until you approve

Tricky data on purpose: uncommitted work, a project edited 4 days ago, a `.env` inside `node_modules`, a lockfile-less project, a VM disk. Backup: recorded run plus the offline planner.

BACKUP IF THE LIVE DEMO FAILS



The scripted request, offline planner: only CS 3140 and hackathon projects are proposed → hoohacks-2026 rejected (uncommitted work) → try 2 passes with the two CS 3140 folders, each with its rebuild command. The other courses, the .env secret, and the VM are never touched.

METHODOLOGY & ENGINEERING METRICS

29

user stories

29 / 14

GitHub issues logged / done
10 closed + 4 built on branch, close at merge

121

automated tests
+ 14-step end-to-end UI test

4.2

tests per issue
every issue has ≥ 2 mapped

100%

runnable tests pass (81/81)
67% of all 121; 40 todo kept red, CI-checked

95.7%

backend line coverage
90.5% branch

100% AI

tests generated by Claude · 14 changed after AI review · **human-refined: 0 so far**, team review before Beta

Tests first, no code (c1c337d) → Rebuild proof green (d2f885d, 454d384) → Claude-path + intent tests red → 81/81 green

Insight: tests and reviews caught 4 real bugs (REG-1…4) and 4 tests that couldn't fail. CI now fails if a todo test ever passes.

STAGE & ROADMAP TO BETA

Alpha: done

✓ Validation run, decision made (Pivot)
✓ 29 stories → 29 GitHub issues with acceptance criteria
✓ Rebuild proof + JS and Python cleanup, real deletes
✓ Honest FREED (measured on disk)
✓ Clean by intent ("done with CS 3140"), caches, conda, unsigned ≠ malware
✓ Claude path tested with a simulated client; CI on every push

Beta: 4 weekly sprints, then a pivot test (dates proposed)

1. Nov 9: record live Claude runs · storage breakdown
2. Nov 16: one-click rebuild, per-action undo, one-line summary
3. Nov 23: Xcode, Docker, ML caches · storage watch
4. Nov 30: Go Pro fake door · test kit · recruit 20 testers

BETA PIVOT TEST: 20 CS STUDENTS WE DON'T KNOW	TARGET
First-session approval of a plan freeing ≥ 10 GB	≥ 60%
Median real space freed	≥ 10 GB
One-click rebuilds that work · unrecoverable deletions	≥ 95% · 0
Moat: prefer us over CleanMyMac's purge, head to head	≥ 50%
"Go Pro" clicks / pre-orders	≥ 15% / 5%

QUESTIONS?

Claude writes the plan. Plain code proves it’s safe. You get the space back.

github.com/natekim416/cs4501_startup · tests: `cd app && npm test`